

Rs 66,058 cr

POST-SIXTH PAY COMMISSION, WAGE BILL OF JUST CENTRAL GOVERNMENT EMPLOYEES. WITH ARREARS, IT WILL TOUCH RS 84,118 CRORE.

PAY AND PENSION EXPENDITURE

YEAR	PAY	YEAR	PENSION
1960-61	417		
1965-66	754	1964-65	31
1970-71	1,186	1969-70	55
1975-76	1,886	1974-75	135
1980-81	2,751	1979-80	349
1985-86	5,422	1984-85	980
1990-91	10,027	1989-90	3,325
1995-96	18,785	1994-95	5,770
2000-01	28,688	1999-00	19,426
2004-05	36,704	2004-05	26,205
2008-09	46,379	2008-09	30,000*

Figures in rupees crore. Source: Indian Public Finance Statistics and Fifth Pay Commission reports; Government of India

* For Central government only

Rs 31,365 cr

IS WHAT THE PENSION BILL OF THE UNION GOVERNMENT WILL BE AFTER THE RECOMMENDATIONS OF THE SIXTH PAY COMMISSION ARE PUT INTO PRACTICE.

■ By Shankkar Aiyar

We distribute vast quantities of foodgrain through our public distribution system. The finding is 36 per cent of the foodgrain does not reach the poor. We have laid out the largest guaranteed wage employment programme as a safety net for the poor. The finding is that there are pockets in India where this programme is not giving the guaranteed wage to the very poor. We have the largest school lunch programme in the world; 130 million children eat a school lunch. The finding is that the quality and the quantity of the food at many places leaves much to be desired. We have very large road building programme. But many of the roads that are laid are of such poor quality that they have to be re-laid every five years, they vanish after three or four years."

This is not the rant of an academic. It is Finance Minister P. Chidambaram describing the quality of governance in the country at the INDIA TODAY Conclave on March 15. Ten days later the Sixth Pay Commission, headed by Justice B.N. Srikrishna, submitted its report arguing the case for a 42 per cent rise in salaries of babus. The hike will add Rs 12,561 crore to the Centre's salary bill of Rs 53,497 crore taking it to Rs 66,058 crore. Add to this Rs 18,060 crore in arrears as the hike will be effective from January 2006 and Rs 1,365 crore towards higher pension. If the political

THE NEW DEAL FOR 20 MILLION GOVERNMENT EMPLOYEES ACROSS THE COUNTRY HAS LITTLE FOR OVER A BILLION INDIANS. IT DELIVERS THE CARROT BUT THERE IS NO STICK TO MAKE BABUDOM DELIVER AND BE MORE ACCOUNTABLE.

DEN OF SLOTH